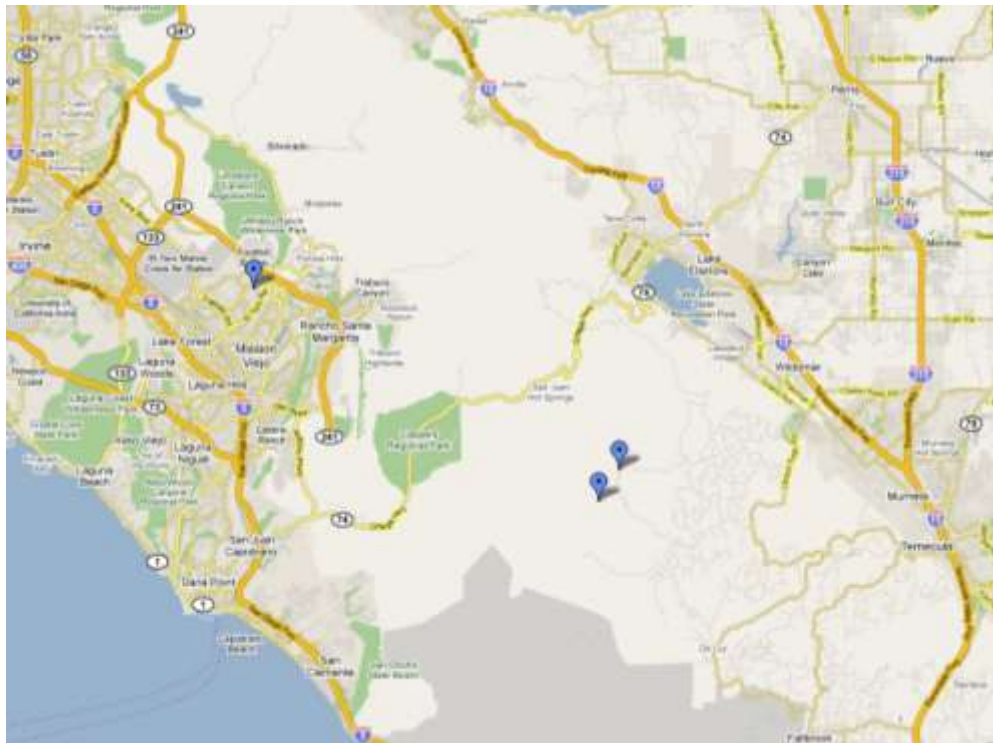


This past weekend was the O2 (on-trail overnight) provisional outing of Thio, a friend or ours from Sierra Club. Kim and I both tagged along to show our support. The published trip only had a few miles of hiking so it was going to be more of a relaxed weekend with friends as opposed to one of my usual hike-till-you-drop style outings.



It also gave me to perfect opportunity to try out my new (and the first I've ever owned) backpacking pack. The blue Gregory is mine while the red is Kim's.



The trip was conveniently located close to where I live. The northwest blue marker is my apartment while the one to the far south is the location of Fisherman's Camp where we would spend the night and the one a northeast of that is the Tenaja Falls Trailhead we would hike in from.



Kim and I elected to meet the group at the trailhead instead of the carpool point so we took our time driving in and enjoying the cloud covered view over Lake Elsinore.



We arrived at the trailhead with no sign of the others so we unloaded our packs and relaxed a bit.





I took advantage of the fact I have a truck...



And Kim fiddled with her pack...



When the others arrived and we were done saying hello Thio gave his official trailhead speech admonishing us to please refrain from any incidents of sexual harassment or personal injury until after the end of the trip. The paperwork for those can be atrocious.





With that we loaded up and took off down the trail.



The day warmed up rapidly as expected but the hike wasn't strenuous at all. We did get some nice views and there was enough water that the creek was flowing in places though it was rarely very deep this time of year.

Fisherman's Camp was previously a campground used by people fishing for steelhead in the nearby San Mateo Creek. At one time it was accessible via dirt road driving but has been hike in only for some time now and to my knowledge there is no longer any fishing in the area.

The campsite itself consists of a open dirt clearing with a large log where most of our group set up and some more remote grassy sites further back in the trees that a few of us chose to set up in.







Despite my threats that I was going to bring along the rather large and heavy Costco car camping tent Kim and I settled on bringing her slightly more snug backpacking tent.

While it was warm the weather was rather pleasant. The only real annoyance was the amount of bugs which seemed only marginally put off by the bug spray we had all drenched ourselves in.



After setting up camp we grabbed a minimal amount of gear and set off on a day hike further south down San Mateo Canyon.





Our goal was one of the pools about a mile away from camp where some of us took advantage of the cool water and took a dip.

After that we continued further south to see the sights. All told we probably did 3 or 4 miles and were shown some rather nice camping sites. The area we were in is the only place in Cleveland National Forest where camping is allowed outside of designated campgrounds as long as you are at least 100 feet from a trail. I found a few places I was interested in going back to during the cooler part of the year.





Eventually we turned back towards camp.



Back in camp we took advantage of a naturally sheltered clearing and did the traditional Sierra Club happy hour where everyone brings some sort of food or drink item to share with the group. As usual there was enough food that Kim and I didn't even make the meal we had brought.

Afterwards everyone sat around and chatted for a time before turning in. No campfires are allowed due to fire danger so it was just headlamps and camping stoves under the stars.

It only got down into the 40s or 50s at night so I wasn't even able to zip up my sleeping bag without overheating.

The next morning we slept in and leisurely made breakfast and packed up our camp.





I insisted on the traditional group shot before we left camp.





By around 11 am we were back at the cars and decided to drop our packs and make a short excursion the opposite direction along the same trail to see the Tenaja Falls.



Now it was rather warm and with the sun beating off the dirt and rocks of the trail I was missing the swimming hole from yesterday.



This was our first view of the falls. We could see a small amount of water running down it from where we were.





While we were admiring the view one of our group noticed an old car in the brush below the trail. These remains are actually rather common out in Cleveland National Forest and all seem to come with a number of old beer cans and bullet holes made by later trigger happy visitors.

We hoofed it the rest of the way to the falls and found there was a nice little pool formed at the bottom.



Close-up of the falls taken before I was politely requested to quit running around on the rocks so far from the group.

After exploring the falls for a bit we headed back to the cars and the trip was done. Thio is now just some paperwork and a few weeks away from being an official Sierra Club leader.

For the rest of the pictures see

<http://www.flickr.com/photos/matthewhengst/sets/72157605398812881/>

-Matthew Hengst

Si Hoc Legere Scis Nimium Eruditionis Habes